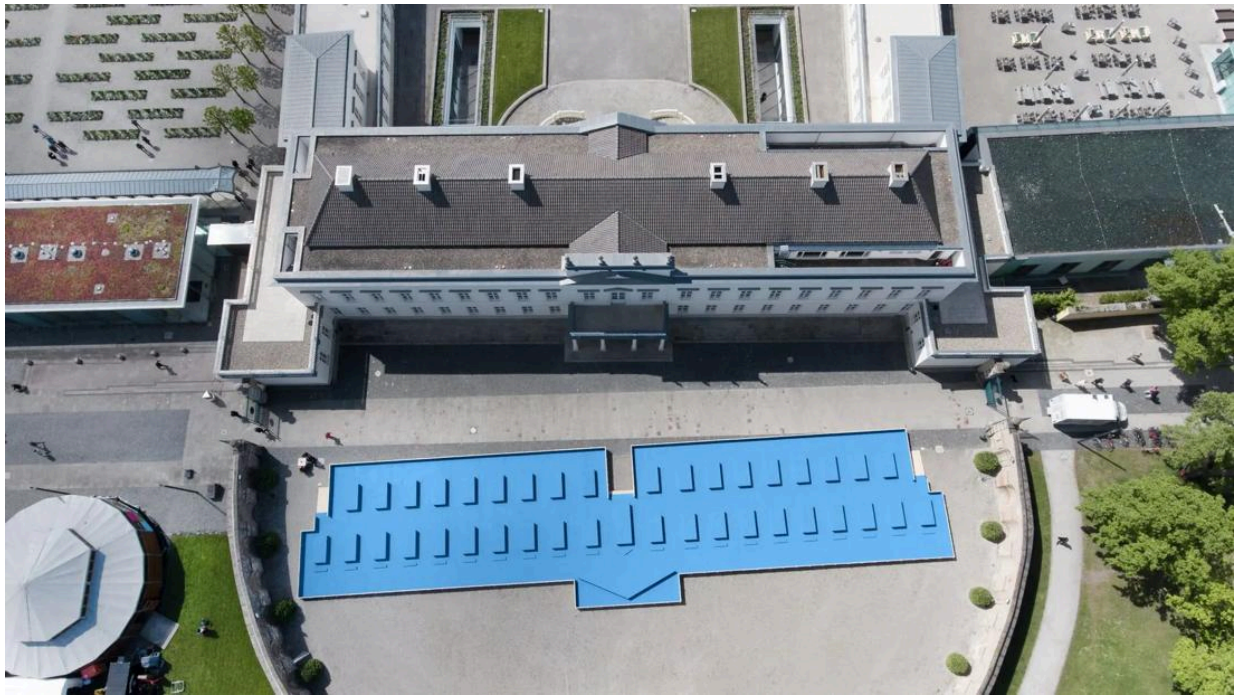
COPY SERVICE

SKULPTUR, HANNOVER, 2019



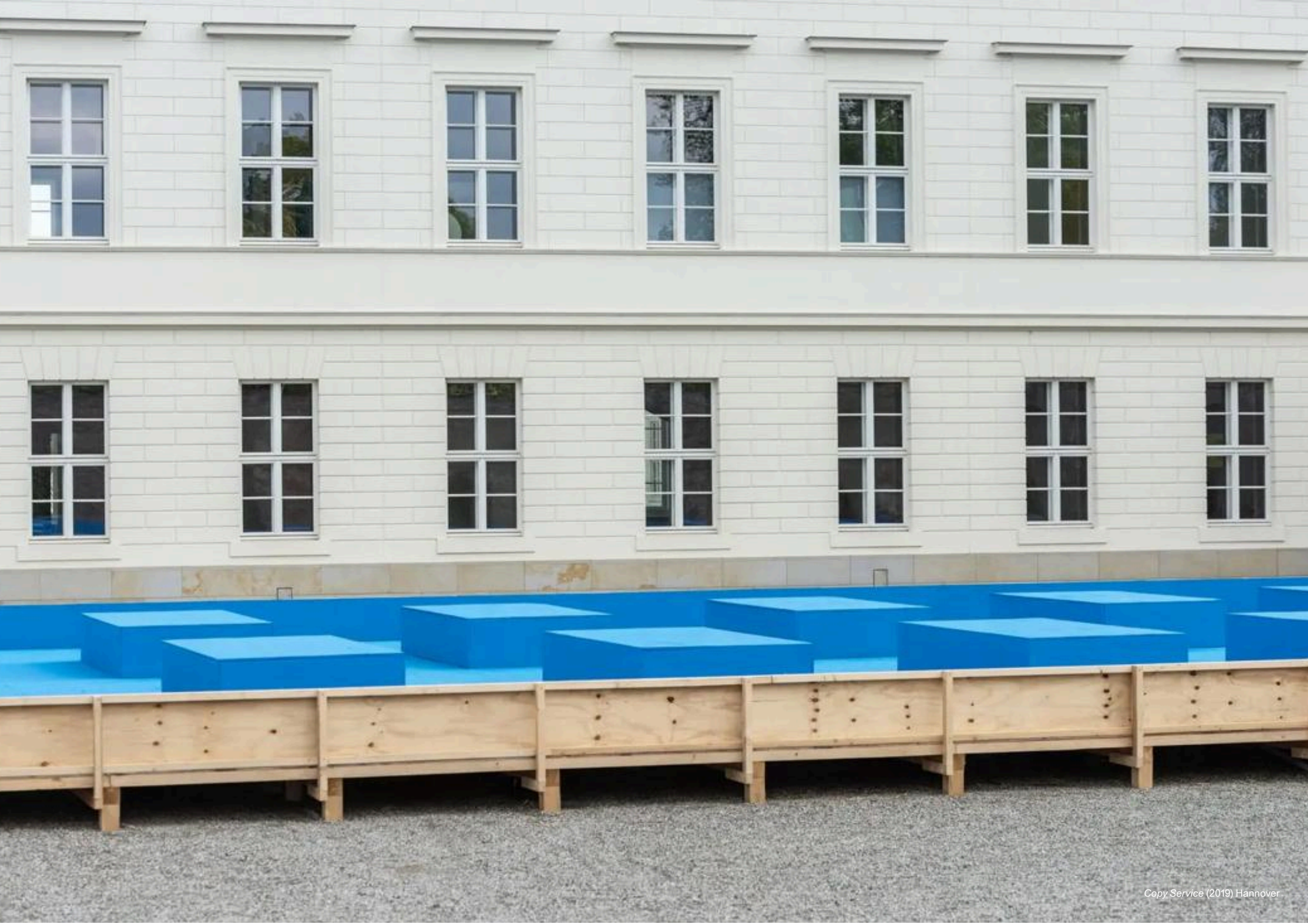
Copy Service (2019) Hannover

The reconstruction of Herrenhausen Palace, destroyed in the Second World War, was the subject of controversial debate in Hanover in the early 2000s. While the reconstruction was meant to enrich the historic cityscape, it also met with criticism, as many citizens questioned the authenticity of a new building.

In May 2019, YRD.Works realised the temporary installation Copy Service as part of the KunstFestSpiele in the cour d'honneur of Herrenhausen Palace. The 75 x 12 x 0.7 metre sculpture lay there like a leftover from the reconstruction, giving the impression of a gigantic casting mould. The bright blue structure reflected the features of the façade in inverted form: window openings became raised surfaces and architectural projections appeared as recesses in the roughly 900-square-metre platform. The negative form made the palace façade look like a reproduction, as if YRD.Works' object had actually served as the mould for the rebuild. In this way, the sculpture inserted itself between the historic building and its replica and suggested a supposed technical link between original and copy.

The industrial appearance of the mould also drew attention to the technical possibility of reproducing buildings. Copy Service thus also pointed to other reconstruction projects such as the rebuilding of Frankfurt's old town or the Berlin Palace, and fundamentally raised the question of the cultural significance of such replicas.

The installation was freely accessible and offered visitors a platform that could also be used as a stage. As in earlier works by YRD.Works, the boundaries between viewing and participation blurred, as the audience itself was actively drawn into the sculpture. At the same time, the platform symbolically opened up the palace, which is otherwise used mainly commercially as an event and conference venue, making it accessible to all of Hanover's citizens for a short time.



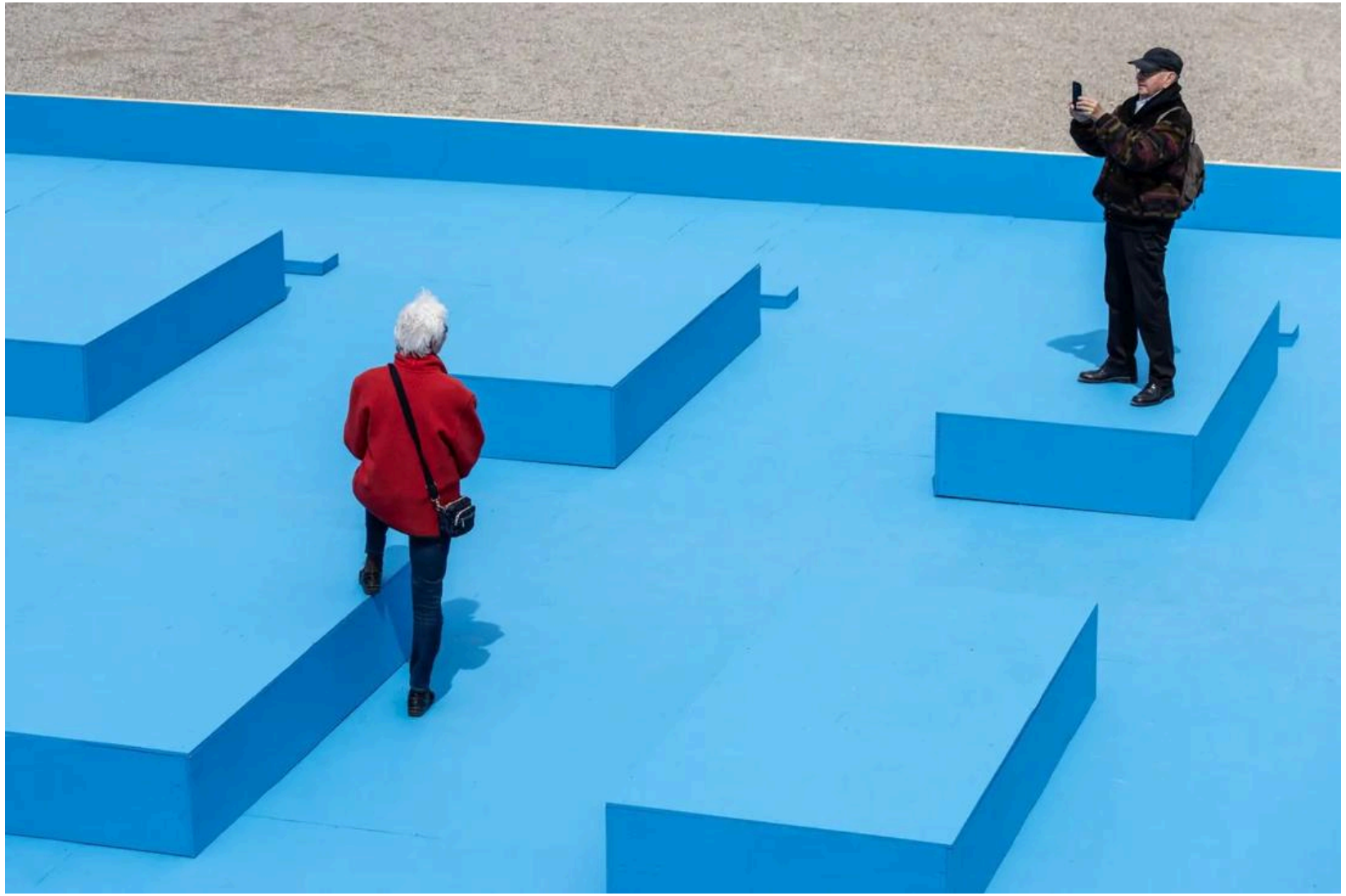
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